Day 72 - Jack Poste, Hopeness, Don Irish

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 96 · Hope Bay and Lion's Head

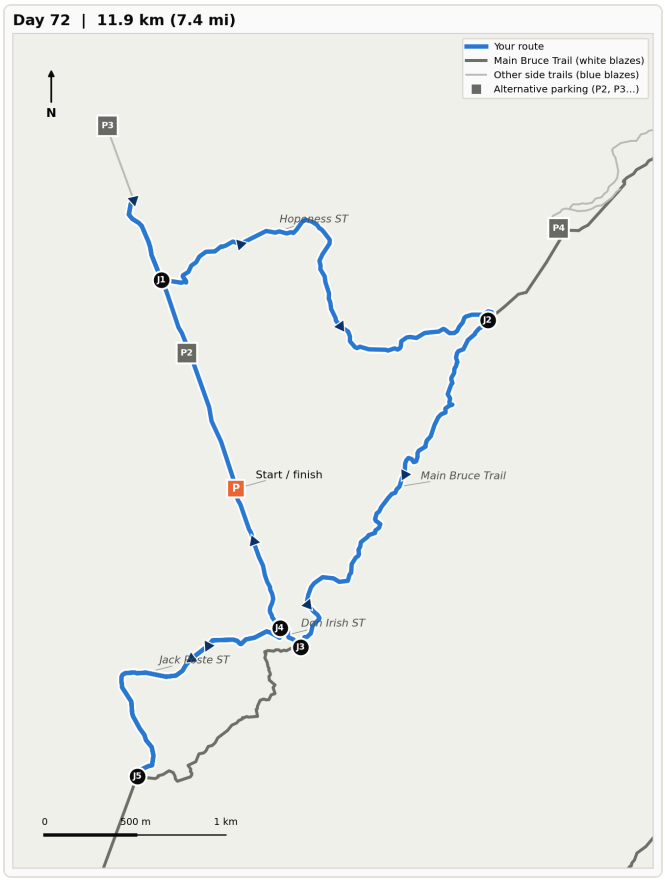
11.9 km / 7.4 mi	~4.3 h	7.3 km new	202 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking at the south end of Cathedral Dr. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day72_hike096.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Jack Poste Side Trail (3.8 km); Hopeness Side Trail (3.3 km); Don Irish Side Trail (0.2 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside parking at the south end of Cathedral Dr.
- **Jack Poste Side Trail:** This side trail leads to glacial potholes worn into the bedrock. Trilliums bloom along it in May. The Hope Bay Lookout nearby gives panoramic views of the bay from the escarpment top.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** Follows the escarpment edge. A 2015 trip report describes this stretch as rugged edge paths with spectacular lookouts and glacial potholes. A signed deep crevice lies along the edge, so keep Zappy close.
- **Wildlife:** A 2020 hiker reported a black bear near the signed crevice. The bear moved off.
- **Hopeness Side Trail and road walking:** The Hopeness Side Trail leads out to Richardson Rd. From there, the Jack Poste Side Trail follows roads, including Hopeness Rd and Cathedral Dr, back to the car. Walk the shoulder with Zappy close.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside parking south of the Hopeness Rd intersection map	Free	0.8	0 m	Jack Poste
P3	Roadside parking on the southeast corner of the junction of Scenic Caves Rd and Richardson Rd map	Free	1.7	460 m	
P4	Bruce Trail parking lot: Located on Jackson's Cove Rd at the top of the hill just to the west... map	Free	5.1	1000 m	

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 5.3 km / 3.3 mi, covering Don Irish, Jack Poste. **Outing 2** from P2 (Roadside parking south of the Hopeness Rd intersection; Free): 7.5 km / 4.7 mi, covering Hopeness, Jack Poste. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions

0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking at the south end of Cathedral Dr. Head north on the blue-blazed Jack Poste Side Trail. The next 0.9 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.9	0.6	Heads-up: The next 0.7 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
1.2	0.8	J1: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Hopeness Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Hopeness Side Trail goes off on your right.) This is a short excursion (about 1010 m in all): walk the whole Hopeness Side Trail, including the short loop or branch near its end (see the map), and come back to this junction.
2.2	1.4	J1: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Hopeness Side Trail, heading east. (the Jack Poste Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
5.0	3.1	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
7.5	4.7	J3: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Don Irish Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
7.7	4.8	J4: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Jack Poste Side Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed Jack Poste Side Trail goes off on your right.)
9.4	5.8	J5: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
11.1	6.9	J4: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Jack Poste Side Trail, heading north-west. (the Don Irish Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
11.3	7.0	Heads-up: The next 0.7 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
11.9	7.4	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails, Narcity and the Vanderplas family's Bruce Trail journal.